Unit 8. 2 Timothy 2:1-7 (Encounter)

Overview

Every module has a number of opportunities for you to be coached in your ability to handle the Bible. This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to 2 Timothy 2:1-7.

Outline

- Introduction
- Worksheet for the passage
- Worksheet for Step 1
- Worksheet for Steps 2 to 4
- Responding to the message of 2 Timothy 2:1-7

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Follow and apply the four steps of Encountering a Bible Passage to a passage from 2 Timothy yourself
2. Share the message of 2 Timothy 2:1-7 with a group of people today

8.1 INTRODUCTION

In this unit you will apply the lessons of Unit 4 to another passage from 2 Timothy (2:1-7). Keep referring back to the four steps in that unit. You might like to think back to your earlier experience of this process and something you found particularly hard to achieve and ask your Trainer for help with that.

Spend time reflecting on the text on the next page. It ends on the theme of reflection – “reflect on what I am saying” – so you might want to give particular time to considering the images Paul uses and pray for insight.

Use a notepad to write the passage out and record observations and work on these before marking the text in this work book, which you will want to keep for reference. You may want to wait until your Trainer marks up a passage before recording it in this book. Use the worksheets on the pages that follow the text in a similar way to before.

Your Trainer will help you and guide you through this process.

8.2 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7 – THE PASSAGE

2 You then, my son, be strong in the
grace that is in Christ Jesus. **2** And the
things you have heard me say in the
presence of many witnesses entrust to
reliable people who will also be qualified
to teach others. **3** Join with me in
suffering, like a good soldier of Christ
Jesus. **4** No one serving as a soldier gets
entangled in civilian affairs, but rather
tries to please his commanding
officer. **5** Similarly, anyone who
competes as an athlete does not receive
the victor's crown except by competing
according to the rules. **6** The hardworking
farmer should be the first to receive a
share of the crops. **7** Reflect on what I am
saying, for the Lord will give you insight
into all this. (NIV)

8.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7 - STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text	
a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?	
b) See the details of the text. List important words, phrases, and relationships:	**c) Seek the meaning from the details** Explain important words, phrases, and relationships:
d) Summarise the findings. What are the main ideas that come out of this initial study?	

8.4 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text **a) Note all the bones in the structure.** What elements highlight the structure?
b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?
STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text **a) State the theme of the passage.** What is the author's main point?
b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?
STEP 4: BRAIN – understand the PURPOSE of the text... **a) State the purpose of the passage.** Why is the author making his point?
b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

8.5 RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

Unit 9. Keeping the gospel central (Reflection)

Overview

This unit flows out of the study of 2 Timothy 2:1-7 and explores ways in which commitment to the gospel shapes the ministry of local church leaders. In doing so it teaches us how to "reflect" on the Scriptures and the situations we face and develops the BUILD 'ERA' model of theological reflection that is used throughout the BUILD curriculum.

Outline

- Introducing theological reflection
- The three steps of theological reflection
- Principles for gospel centred ministry
- 'ERA': A further look at the steps of theological reflection
- The BUILD logic of gospel ministry

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Recall and arrange the steps of theological reflection
2. Apply the steps of theological reflection to issues you encounter
3. Plan steps to make the gospel more central to your ministry
4. Use the acronym 'BUILD' to present the logic of gospel ministry

9.1 INTRODUCING THEOLOGICAL REFLECTION

9.1.1 What challenges are you facing?

We have seen that Timothy faced some very real challenges. Some individuals were distorting the gospel and destroying the church. We too face many struggles and difficulties in our own ministries.

- Individually or in a group: Identify a challenge or problem you are facing. If you are in a group write these down and then underline one or two that will benefit from further discussion later on in the unit. (NOTE: It might be a situation in your life or the life of your church that is puzzling. Or it might be a Scripture that is challenging.)

9.1.2 Going further and deeper

All too often our responses to the different experiences we face and the studies in the Bible we do are quickly forgotten and rarely lead to real change. Why is this the case and how can we go further and deeper? Discuss this together.

- Why do you think that so much teaching and learning fails to bring about any real change in people's lives? Where do you think the problem lies?

- How can we make sure that our encounters with the situations we face and the Scriptures God has given us lead to real learning and action?

9.1.3 "Reflect"

In the passage we have just encountered (2 Tim 2:1-7), Paul tells Timothy to pass on the gospel as a servant of Christ in the strength of Christ. Paul uses three pictures to illustrate what that means in practice and makes it clear to Timothy that he must do more than just read his words.

Paul knew that **reflection** was essential for real learning to take place and for action to happen. And so he ends that passage with a command that comes with a wonderful promise (2 Tim 2:7): "Reflect on what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all this."

- Memorise that verse now and consider the importance of careful reflection and the Lord's kindness in opening the eyes of our hearts to his truths.

9.2 THE THREE STEPS OF THEOLOGICAL REFLECTION

How can we reflect more deeply and effectively on God's word and God's world? We will explore that question by looking more closely at Paul's words in 2 Tim 2:7 and by exploring one of the issues that you identified at the beginning of the unit.

As we do so we will discover that theological reflection is a three step process that encourages learning and action:

1. It begins when we **encounter** something in God's world and/or God's word with a desire for wisdom.

2. It continues with **reflection** on those situations and Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.

3. It leads to **action** in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.

9.2.1 Encounter

The first step is:

To encounter something in God's world and God's word with a desire for wisdom.

Paul tells Timothy to reflect "on" something. Theological reflection is an encounter with Scripture or experience. Scripture takes priority when it comes to shaping belief and behaviour, but we always encounter God's word in the context of the world around us.

Timothy is called to reflect on God's word in the midst of the situation he was facing. We too are to reflect on God's word in the context of all that is going on in our lives and churches and communities. Sometimes the issue or challenge is something we meet in the midst of our ministry. Sometimes it is something we meet in the Bible.

In the discipline of encounter you first **describe** things and you then **discover** things. That work of description and discovery involves asking and answering questions:

1. How did events unfold? Tell the story of what you experienced.
2. Who was involved in the experience? Describe the people.
3. What were the various people doing and saying? Record what happened.
4. Where and when did the events take place? Describe the situation.
5. What key things have you discovered that will need further reflection? List the different issues that have come to your attention.

- Apply the questions above to one of the challenges or issues you noted as a group at the beginning.

Summary points for the <u>encounter</u> step of theological reflection:

- To <u>encounter</u> something is to meet something new, surprising and unsettling.
- You need to <u>describe</u> the things you encounter and your reactions.
- You must list the <u>discoveries</u> you have made.

Your initial description and the discoveries you make will only be shallow. They will not explain the fuller meaning and significance of the encounter or experience. You must resist jumping to conclusions. Rather than taking action immediately you need to pause and go deeper by taking the next step.

9.2.2 Reflection

The second step is:

Reflection on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.

In 2 Timothy 2:7 Paul commands Timothy to "reflect" on what he has said about gospel ministry. Remember that any "insight" is a gift from "the Lord". Reflection is an opportunity for God to break into our lives, which means we need to make space for God's grace through prayer in the process. Do not rely on your own understanding.

In his reflection Timothy must consider three word pictures Paul has used: the images of soldier, athlete and farmer. It often helps if there is a *visual* aspect to our reflection, which helps us to think in fresh ways. (Diagrams, drawings and maps can help the process.)

But the most important thing is to *keep the gospel at the centre of your theological reflection*, to consider the situation in the light of God's good news. In verse 7 Timothy is called to "reflect" on God's word through Paul and in verse 8 to "remember" Jesus Christ, the heart of Paul's "gospel".

In the discipline of reflection you **consider** your discoveries and develop **principles**. Considering and developing principles means asking and answering questions:

1. Why might these things be happening? Note the reasons that might lie behind the description and discoveries. Give explanations.
2. What light does the gospel, the good news of God's grace, shed on all this? Keep the gospel at the heart of your reflection.
3. What Bible passages and themes are particularly relevant to the problem? List a few Scriptures that you think are important.
4. What pictures come to mind that help you to understand God's perspective on it? Explain any illustrations or draw any diagrams that help you to understand what is going on.
5. What principles seem to come from this process? List these lessons.

- Apply these questions to the discoveries you have made about the challenge or issue you noted as a group.

Summary points for the <u>reflection</u> step of theological reflection:

- To <u>reflect</u> is to pause for thought rather than to react. It is to question, to think and go deeper, to chew things over.
- You need to <u>consider</u> the discoveries you have made in the light of the God's word and in his presence.
- You must list the <u>principles</u>, the new perspectives or ways of looking at life and ministry that come from this.

It is tempting to leave these principles as interesting topics for discussion, as many academics do. But rather than leaving them as theories on a page, you need to put what you have learnt into practice and take the final step and prepare to take action.

9.2.3 Action

The final step is:

Action in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.

Paul calls Timothy to reflect on his words, which are God's words, for a purpose: so that he can be strengthened for a demanding ministry. Action is therefore not just about what you do but is also about why you do it, it is to be guided by the gospel.

Action means **planning** new approaches to ministry, testing things out and developing new **practice**.

We need to test our reflection by making a plan and taking action. We need to ask and answer questions such as:

1. How might all this change my attitudes?
2. What action can I take that will put these principles into practice?
3. What plans can I make in order to achieve this? (Make plans, whether formally or informally.)

- Apply these questions to the principles you have drawn out of your reflection on the challenge or issue you noted as a group. Note some of your plans below.

Summary points for the action step of theological reflection:

- To take action is to do something new or in a new way.
- You need to plan to put the principles into practice.
- The outcome will be new practice: ministry and mission that is more faithful to the gospel.

9.2.4 Summary table for the three steps of theological reflection

Step and description	Definition	Activity	Outcome
Encounter something in God's world and God's word with a desire for wisdom.	To meet something new and surprising	Describe	Discoveries
Reflection on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.	Pause for thought and go deeper	Consider	Principles
Action in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.	Do something new or different	Plan	Practice

- Make sure you have understood the summary table ask and clarify any questions here.

9.3 PRINCIPLES FOR KEEPING THE GOSPEL CENTRAL

We have looked at some issues we are facing today in the light of the gospel, and we have been challenged to keep the gospel central in our life and ministry.

One way of listing, considering and remembering some of the principles we have noted is to use the letters that make up the word gospel – G O S P E L.

See if you can think of words that fit with the principles you have discovered and the plans you have made which begin with the letters G and O and S and P and E and L.

For example, the letter G might stand for 'God', because keeping the gospel central means honouring him. His will and his ways matter more than anything else.

You might think of more than one word for each letter. Pick the best two and use them in the table below. Your Trainer can help you with this.

Principles for keeping the gospel central to our life and ministry:

God – keeping the gospel central means honouring God. His will and his ways matter more than anything else.	**G**
O	**O**
S	**S**
P	**P**
E	**E**
L	**L**

9.4 'ERA': A FURTHER LOOK AT THE STEPS OF THEOLOGICAL REFLECTION

9.4.1 The word 'ERA' is a simple way to remember the steps

In English the word **'ERA'** is a simple and helpful way of remembering these three steps:

> **E** is for **Encounter**, **R** is for **Reflection**, **A** is for **Action**.

And this way of remembering the steps has real meaning. The word 'era' means a significant period of history. For example, the reign of a king is known as the era of that ruler.

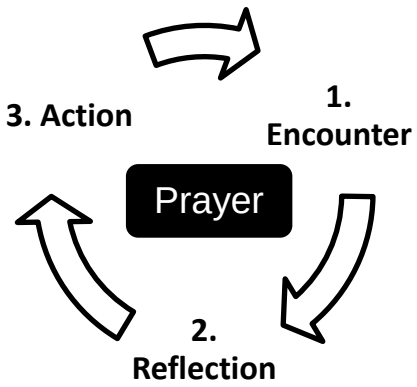
That is why ERA is a helpful way of remembering this cycle: the reason we wrestle with the situations we face in the light of the gospel, and the reason we then return to the often difficult context of God's world in order to take action in a renewed way is to bring about change and transformation.

The change we are seeking is that God's "will be done, on earth as it is in heaven" (Matt 6:10). In other words, the aim of our reflection is to point to God's Kingdom, the new era God is bringing in and through his king Jesus.

9.4.2 The steps of theological reflection as a cycle

Having encountered God's world and God's word we reflect and then act. But as we take action in God's world with the wisdom of God's word we will make fresh discoveries and have new experiences. Those new encounters will deepen our reflection and refine our action.

This means that the three steps of encounter, reflection and action can be understood as steps in a cycle. That cycle is illustrated below.



Prayer lies at the heart of the process because that desire for wisdom must be continuous throughout:

> "If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to you." (James 1:5)

9.5 EXTRA: THE BUILD LOGIC OF GOSPEL MINISTRY

To close this unit we will link this learning to the word 'BUILD'. In Unit 1 we learnt the meaning of the acronym 'BUILD':

B	is for	**Biblical** …	2 Tim 3:16-17
U	is for	**Understanding** …	2 Tim 2:15
I	is for	**In-service** …	2 Tim 1:8
L	is for	**Leadership** …	2 Tim 2:2
D	is for	**Development** …	2 Tim 3:14

Here we will build on this by seeing that the order in which the letters B – U – I – L – D come can be used to teach an important logic to gospel ministry, a pattern that we have been discovering in this unit.

9.5.1 The order of the letters B – U – I – L – D and the words they represent

First, the order of the letters BUILD and the words they stand for is important. Consider the order they are in below:

1. Biblical
The Bible and its gospel are of immense value
"Scripture..." (2 Tim 3:16-17)

🡻

2. Understanding
We must use it all with great care
"Handles..." (2 Tim 2:15)

🡻

3. In-service
That includes using it in practice in mission
"Reflect..." (2 Tim 2:7)

🡻

4. Leadership
And in passing on true gospel ministry to others
"Entrust..." (2 Tim 2:2)

🡻

5. Development
This is an ongoing commitment
"Continue..." (2 Tim 3:14)

Think about the importance of that order and progression:

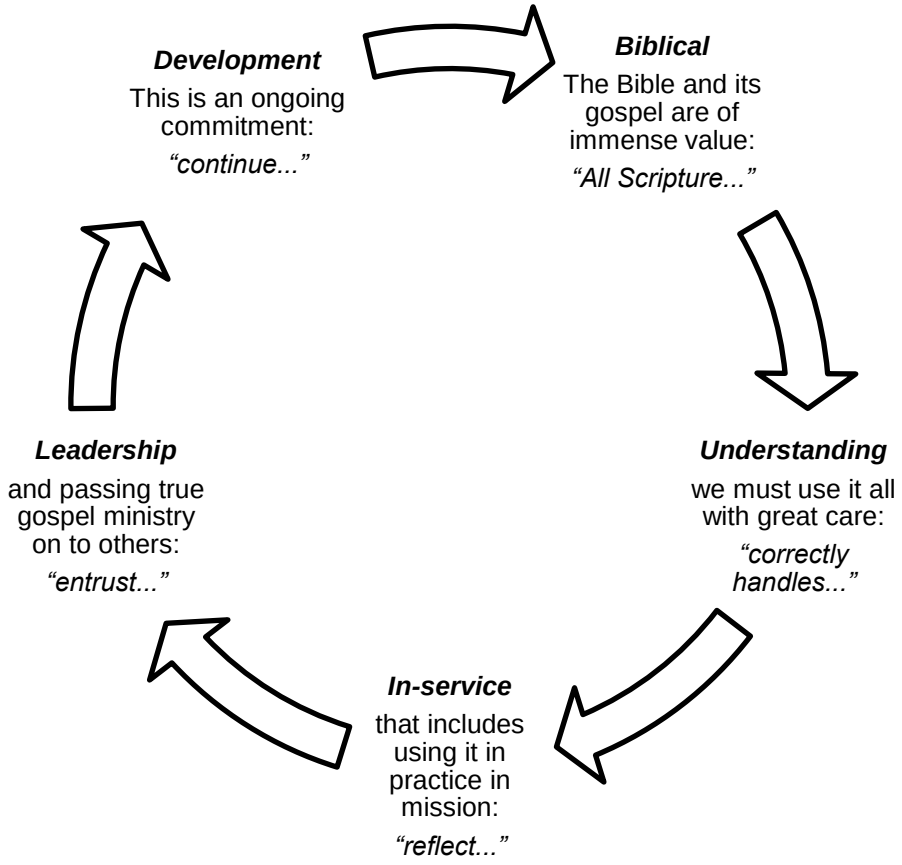
> First, the Bible is a great treasure that bears God's authority.
>
> So, second, we must handle it and the glorious gospel it contains, the word of truth, with great care.
>
> Third, following on from that, careful use of Scripture and truth is not simply about preserving the gospel, it is about sharing it and being strengthened by it. The Bible and the word of life it contains are God's gift for a church on a mission.
>
> And, fourth, part of that mission is to pass it on to others: to train trustworthy and true ministers of the gospel.
>
> Fifth and finally, all this is an ongoing process that involves every dimension of our lives: all true teachers of the gospel must continue in what they have learnt and have become convinced of, watching both life and doctrine.

9.5.2 The BUILD learning cycle

This order can also be understood as a cycle. If you are going to grow as a leader you must "continue in what you have learnt" (2 Tim 3:14). Therefore it is important to see that the letters 'BUILD' form a cycle of growth and learning. Persevering in the ongoing process of true gospel ministry means the following. We must:

1. Constantly return to Scripture (Biblical)
2. Renew our grasp of the gospel (Understanding)
3. Use the gospel more and more in practice (In-service)
4. Develop ourselves as leaders as we develop others (Leadership)
5. Continue with this, encouraged by the joys and despite the disappointments (Development)

This is illustrated below:



- Read through the cycle and make sure you understand the logic of the steps. Try and explain them to another participant in order to test out and improve your understanding.

- End by explaining to the others in your group which step you find the most challenging, and pray about some of the issues that raises.

Unit 10. 2 Timothy 3:14-17 (Encounter)

This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to 2 Timothy 3:14-17. Refer back to previous 'Encountering the Bible' units for learning outline and outcomes.

NOTE: Verses 10-13 provide important background to the passage and the contrast that is made there ("But as for you…"). Do not forget to look at those verses when you 'Set the passage in context'.

10.1 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17 – THE PASSAGE

14 But as for you, continue in what you have learned and have become convinced of, because you know those from whom you learned it, **15** and how from infancy you have known the Holy Scriptures, which are able to make you wise for salvation through faith in Christ Jesus. **16** All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, **17** so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work. (NIV)

10.2 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17 – STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text	
a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?	
b) See the details of the text. List important words, phrases, and relationships:	**c) Seek the meaning from the details** Explain important words, phrases, and relationships:
d) Summarise the findings. What are the main ideas that come out of this initial study?	

10.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text **a) Note all the bones in the structure.** What elements highlight the structure?
b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?
STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text **a) State the theme of the passage.** What is the author's main point?
b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?
STEP 4: BRAIN – understand the PURPOSE of the text... **a) State the purpose of the passage.** Why is the author making his point?
b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

10.4 RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

Unit 11. The Bible and biblical ministry (Reflection)

Overview

This unit flows out of the study of 2 Timothy 3:14-17. It explores the nature and the purpose of the Bible and what that means for ministry in practice. It follows the BUILD ERA model of reflection; the 'Action' component focuses on personal Bible study and prayer.

Outline

- Introduction to the Bible and biblical ministry
- Encountering different views of the Bible
- Reflection to gain wisdom about God's word
- Action flowing from the nature and purpose of Scripture
- Conclusion
- EXTRA: The BUILD modules and the flow of the Bible

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Repeat the process of theological reflection learnt in Unit 9
2. Show what 2 Timothy says about the nature and purpose of the Bible
3. Explain how the nature of the Bible relates to its purpose
4. Evaluate the relationship between private and public Bible study and prayer
5. Apply the lessons of Unit 10 to personal Bible study
6. Present a simple pattern of Bible study to others

11.1 INTRODUCTION TO THE BIBLE AND BIBLICAL MINISTRY

The passage we have just encountered contains an important statement about the nature and the purpose of Scripture:

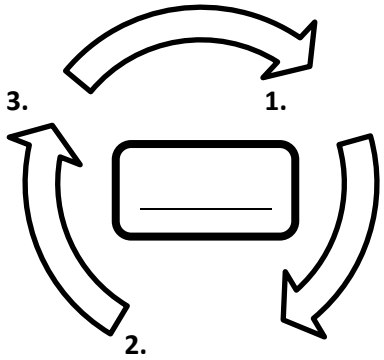
> "All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work." (2 Tim 3:16-17)

The letter 'B' in the word 'BUILD' stands for 'Biblical' and we have already learnt a number of things about the Bible. For example in Unit 2 we learnt that the Bible, God's written word, is the principal and controlling way in which we hear God's voice today. This unit takes this further by looking in more depth at the nature and purpose of the Bible.

Unit 9 introduced some steps of theological reflection:

- What were the three steps and what word helps us to remember them?

- The steps can also be understood as a cycle. Can you fill in the blanks in the diagram below?



The summary table for the three steps of theological reflection is given again below:

Step and description	Definition	Activity	Outcome
Encounter something in God's world and God's word with a desire for wisdom.	To meet something new and surprising	Describe	Discoveries
Reflection on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.	Pause for thought and go deeper	Consider	Principles
Action in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.	Do something new or different	Plan	Practice

Keep returning to this table as you go through the unit.

11.2 ENCOUNTERING DIFFERENT VIEWS OF THE BIBLE

Remember, the first step is to **encounter** something in God's world and/or God's word with a desire for wisdom. In this case it is the issue of the Bible and biblical ministry.

On this occasion we will first encounter our own ideas and those of others around us before encountering God's word on the matter. There are reasons for this. Firstly, it is often easier to describe our own experiences and the experiences of others before looking at the Bible. Secondly, that then naturally prepares us to see what the Bible says by way of connection or contrast.

11.2.1 Encountering different views of the Bible in the world around us

Think first about yourself and the world around you. Put a mirror up to your own life and ministry as well as considering what others are saying and doing and describe your attitudes to the Bible and your understanding of it. These questions will help you:

- Describe some of the things that you hear people saying about the Bible in churches or elsewhere in society.

- What other sources of wisdom and insight do people turn to for direction or help in their lives and ministries?

- What do people mean when they claim that their ministry is ‘biblical’?

- How would you describe the place the Bible has in your ministry and the ministry of those around you?

11.2.2 Encountering what God’s word says about the Bible

Now begin to describe what you have been learning in the Pastoral Epistles and the discoveries you have been making, particularly in 2 Timothy. Focus on 2 Timothy 3:14-17 before discussing any other passages that you have noticed on this theme.

- What do you think the Christians in Ephesus were saying about the Scriptures? Defend your answer with evidence from specific chapters and verses.

- What is striking about what 2 Timothy 3:14-17 and other parts of the Pastoral Epistles have to say about the Bible?

- What have you encountered in our studies so far? Begin to describe what the epistles seem to be saying about the Bible.

11.3 REFLECTION TO GAIN WISDOM ABOUT GOD'S WORD

11.3.1 Considering the issue and developing principles

Remember, the second step is to **reflect** on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom. In the discipline of reflection you **consider** your discoveries and develop **principles**, in this case about the Bible and biblical ministry.

Take a step back and **consider** carefully what we have encountered in God’s world and God’s word. Remember that diagrams, drawings and even maps of a local community can help this process of reflection. You could picture the place of Scripture in the place and find ways of drawing that. Or you might want to return to the BUILD emblem or logo in Unit 1, section 1. Begin to capture some **principles** that you are learning.

Ask and answer questions such as:

- Why might people have these attitudes and understandings? Note the reasons behind the description and discoveries. Give explanations.

- What light does the gospel, the good news of God's grace, shed on our understanding of the Bible, what it is and what it does? Keep the gospel at the heart of your reflection.

- What Bible passages and themes are particularly relevant as you form principles about the Bible and its place in ministry? List a few Scriptures that are important.

- What pictures come to mind that help you to understand God's perspective on the Bible and its place in ministry? Draw any diagrams or maps that help you to understand what is going on.

- What principles seem to come from this process? List these lessons you are learning.

11.3.2 Drawing together some principles about the Bible

Your Trainer will help you to draw some of these ideas together under two headings:

1. The nature of the Bible – "All Scripture is …" (2 Tim 3:16)

2. The purpose of the Bible – "… and is useful for …" (2 Tim 3:16)

Your Trainer will be able to help and guide you in this under those headings.

1. The nature of the Bible

a) Our Bible is God's words through people's words
"All Scripture is God-breathed..." Some translations say "inspired" by God. This does not mean the Bible is an inspiring or exciting story. It is inspirational and exciting but it is so much more than that. "Inspired" means that it is breathed out by God the Holy Spirit. The words we read are God's words. But they are also human words, one and at the same time. Paul commands Timothy to "reflect on what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all this". As we read Paul's writing we become aware that he had a sense that he was speaking God's words. 2 Peter clearly makes that claim when he says this:

> "Bear in mind that our Lord's patience means salvation, **just as our dear brother Paul also wrote you with the wisdom that God gave him**. He writes the same way in all his letters, speaking in them of these matters. His letters contain some things that are hard to understand, which ignorant and unstable people distort, **as they do the other Scriptures**, to their own destruction" (2 Peter 3:15-16).

Paul's words and the words of the other apostles were considered to be God's words. The Bible is God's word through human words. God is the Bible's primary author, but he communicates through human authors. So what?

The Bible is people's words…	**The Bible is God's words…**
Each book of the Bible has a particular historical setting and audience in mind.	The Bible is relevant for all people in all places at all times.
We need to take the context into account and aim to discover the original meaning of any passage for its audience.	We need to handle it carefully, submit to its message and discover the relevance of any passage for us today.
The question of what it **meant** originally is vital.	The question of what it **means** today is equally important.
Explanation is important.	**Application** is important.

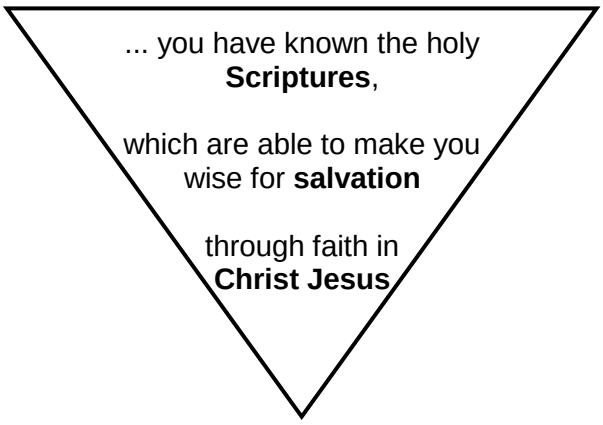
b) Our Bible has been formed around Christ the Messiah
Remember that Paul would not have had the Bible we have today; he was writing parts of the Bible. So how did the Bible come into being? Paul would have had access to the Old Testament Scriptures and some of the early writings about Christ and possibly some letters. Paul asked Timothy to "bring... my scrolls, especially the parchments" in 2 Timothy 4:13.

Because of the nature of the Bible – with Christ and Salvation at the centre – the Bible forms itself around those, as though Christ and the gospel were a magnet.

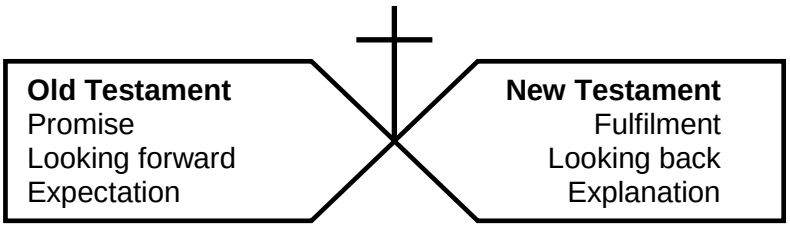
We trust the Bible because we trust Christ himself. He is our starting point and Christ himself trusted the Old Testament Scriptures and referred to them repeatedly (excluding the Apocrypha, which has value but is not Scripture). Jesus then predicted the formation of the New Testament, through the writings of the Apostles, helped by the Holy Spirit. Jesus explains this in John 16:12-15. The church then closed the Bible once all the writings that were clearly Apostolic and that pointed to Christ and the gospel were gathered together.

c) Our Bible links the Scriptures with Salvation and the Saviour
The Bible is the words of God (Scriptures) about the word of God (the gospel) which is all about the Word of God (Christ, the saviour).

2 Timothy 3:15



d) Our Bible links the Old Testament and the New Testament
Building on this, because of the relationship between Scripture and salvation and the Saviour there is a unity to the Bible – both Old Testament and New Testament belong together and are a single story on the single theme of salvation with the one hero, God in Christ. We saw this in Unit 3, point the Participants back to that unit and this simple illustration:



The Old Testament is like a light shining ahead to Christ and the New Testament – Christ and the New Testament only makes sense in the light of the Old Testament.

The New Testament is like a light shining back on Christ and the Old Testament – Christ and the Old Testament only makes sense in the light of the New Testament.

e) Our Bible is sufficient and complete
The outcome of this unity of the Bible, which forms around Christ and the gospel, is that it is complete and sufficient. In the last unit we could not help noticing the words in 2 Tim 3:16 that spoke of the completeness of the Bible:

> "All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, [17]so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work."

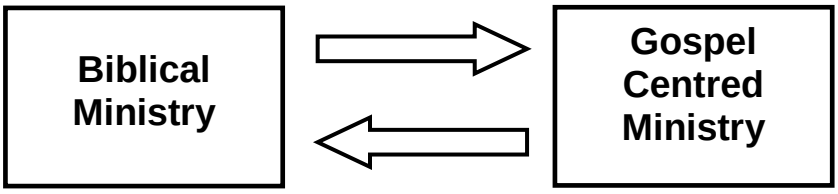
There is no hint that anything else is needed. This is encouraging. Scripture is enough for salvation and for knowing the saviour. Yes, other books are useful, but they are not essential, as we have already noted.

2. The purpose of the Bible

The nature of Scripture leads to its purpose. Just as there are five points we have made about the nature of Scripture (like five fingers on one hand) we can make five points about the purpose of Scripture (like five fingers on another hand). All of these link together.

The nature of Scripture	**The purpose of Scripture**
a) It is God's words through people's words	It directs our preaching and teaching
b) It has Christ at the centre	It points people to Christ
c) It is about salvation and leads to the Saviour	It leads people to be saved through Christ
d) It is formed around Christ and his gospel and teaches that gospel	It preserves the gospel and makes it central
e) It is sufficient in every way	It equips leaders

We have talked about 'Gospel centred ministry' – Biblical ministry is inseparable from Gospel centred ministry. Gospel centred ministry means that we will want to keep rediscovering and rejoicing in the Gospel that the Bible teaches. And the more we look at the Bible the more we will be excited by and driven by the true gospel in presents.



11.4 ACTION FLOWING FROM THE NATURE AND PURPOSE OF SCRIPTURE

Paul tells Timothy that Scripture is *useful*, it is a practical book. But we need to use it according to its nature and purpose, which we have learnt about. We have noted five areas in which it is useful:

a) For preaching and teaching

b) For pointing people to Christ

c) For leading people to salvation

d) For keeping the gospel central

e) For equipping leaders

All five are connected together in different ways. One way is that the first four feed into the last, “so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work” (2 Tim 3:17).

And that includes taking the nature and purpose of Scripture very seriously in our own lives. We must be equipped by the word if we are to equip others from the word; we need to watch our own “life and doctrine closely” (1 Tim 4:16).

The rest of this unit will focus on our own, personal, study of Scripture and the prayer that belongs with it.

11.4.1 Personal Bible study and prayer

Discuss these questions:

- Is Christian ministry a profession or a vocation? In other words, to what extent is our ministry a position we hold in the church and how much is it about God’s calling on our lives? At what points do you feel a sense of conflict between your position as a church leader and your personal call to serve God?

- It is all too easy for church leaders to be so busy feeding others from God’s word that they starve themselves. Have you ever felt like that? How did it come to that point and how have you been able to change the situation?

The life-giving message is not simply something to be passed on and taught. Timothy must live by the Bible and benefit from its gospel and teaching. For example, he also says, “You then, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus” (2 Tim 2:1).

The Pastoral Epistles have a great deal to say about the disciplines of Bible study and prayer, both public and private, and Paul links those disciplines to Timothy’s own spiritual health as well as to the health of the local church.

- In groups ‘skim read’ 1 Timothy and 2 Timothy and note where Paul talks directly or indirectly about Bible study and prayer, both in public and in private.
  (To ‘skim read’ means to cast your eye quickly down the text in order to spot these ideas.)
  Begin with 1 Timothy and focus on 1 Tim 2:1-8; 1 Tim 3:1-10; 1 Tim 4:6-16.
  If you have time go back to 2 Timothy and look at 2 Tim 1:13-14; 2 Tim 2:1-7, 14-15, 22-26; 2 Tim 3:14-17; and 2 Tim 4:1-5.

- As you do this, fill in the table below using those discoveries, noting down some verses and the ideas they contain.

1. Public use of the Bible	**2. Public Prayer**
For example: 1 Tim 4:13	For example: 1 Tim 2:1-2, 8
3. Private use of the Bible	**4. Private Prayer**

Both Bible study and prayer are essential for our spiritual health. But what we do publicly should be an expression of what we do privately, on our own before God. Read 1 Tim 4:6 again, which makes the link between our private faith and our public ministry. Our public prayer and study must flow from a genuine personal experience. Jesus tells us not to be hypocrites (Matt 6:5-15).

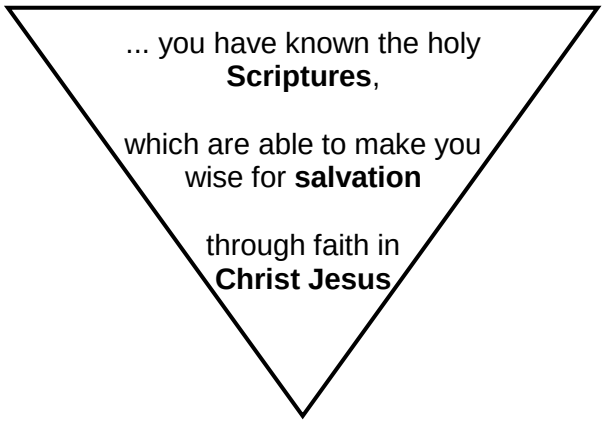
- To what extent is that true of your life and the life of others in your group? Be honest with one another and before God and end any discussion in prayer.

11.4.2 Studying the Bible according to the nature of the Bible

What we learnt in the last unit about the Bible and biblical ministry will help us to study the Bible in private as well as in public.

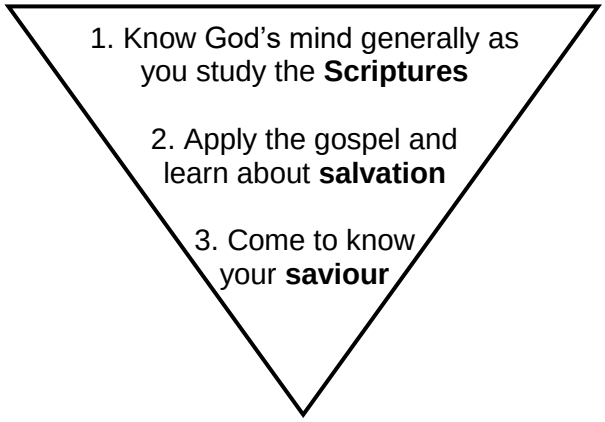
For example, we noticed the relationship between Scripture, Salvation and the Saviour.

2 Timothy 3:15



That means that we need to study the Bible with those three elements in mind. We need to ‘go with the grain’ and study Scripture in the way that God has designed it to be studied (just as we saw that a sculptor uses the grain within the wood he is working on). As you read the Bible for yourself and for your own encouragement bear in mind these three things:

2 Timothy 3:15



In John's gospel Jesus commands us to take all three steps through this warning to the religious leaders of his day:

> "You study the Scriptures diligently because you think that in them you have eternal life. These are the very Scriptures that testify about me, yet you refuse to come to me to have life" (John 5:39-40).

- How can we make sure that our own study of the Scriptures lead to salvation in and through Jesus?

- Look back at the last unit and note how other aspects of the nature and purpose of the Bible can help you to study it and receive God's grace through it.

11.4.3 A pattern for personal Bible study

The principles we have been learning for encountering the Bible apply to personal Bible study and prayer too. But it is helpful to have a simple way of approaching the Bible on a daily basis to hear from God. The more we study the Bible in depth for public ministry the more it will help us to hear God's word in private; and the more we hear God's voice in private, the more it will empower our public preaching.

Here is one simple pattern to follow, which can apply to any passage of Scripture. Again it uses the word 'GOSPEL' to help us to remember it, and as such it is a way of preaching the gospel to ourselves day by day:

G is for **God**
As you meditate on a Bible passage look first for what it teaches about **God**. Focus particularly on God's character, beginning with his might and majesty.

O is for **Ourselves**
The Bible also tells us the truth about **ourselves**. It is a mirror in which we see our own brokenness. Look for ways in which the passage shows up your sinfulness, as well as any signs of God's love for you.

S is for **Salvation**
Turn to note anything that points us to our **salvation** in Christ Jesus. These might be truths that lead you to Christ's saving work on the cross.

P is for **Promise**
There may be indicators of the **promise** of the God's Holy Spirit and his grace and gifts for us today. Truths about the work of the promised Holy Spirit can bring us assurance of all that God has done for us.

E is for **Eternity**
The passage may point you to **eternity**, to the life of the world to come, or to Christ's return and his future judgement. If it does, it is important to take that perspective into your day.

L is for **Life**
Finally apply all this to your **life** today. Look for commands to obey, examples to follow, warnings to heed, or promises you can hold on to. Apply the message to your hopes and fears for the day.

- Practise this approach now as a group on a passage from the Pastoral Epistles. Take Titus 3:3-8 for example.

Here are some other practical suggestions:

1. Use lectionary readings for this discipline, and select a short passage to reflect on. This provides a balanced diet.

2. Use a notebook and pen so that you can concentrate and develop ideas.

3. Write down and memorise a key verse in the text to take into the day.

4. Imagine someone asking you what God has said to you from his word today. How would you answer them?

- Share other ideas in your group to help one another to feed from the Scriptures.

11.4.4 Praying from the word

There is no better moment to pray than as you study the Bible or straight after you have finished. As God speaks to you, respond in prayer. Many people find the acronym 'ACTS' a helpful one to use.

A is for **Adoration**. Turn what you have learnt about the Lord into praise.

C is for **Confession**. That will automatically lead to the confession of sin.

T is for **Thanksgiving**. First for your salvation, as you continue to preach the gospel to yourself, and then for the many other blessings God has given you.

S is for **Supplication**. 'Supplication' means to ask for something, we can end by laying our requests before God.

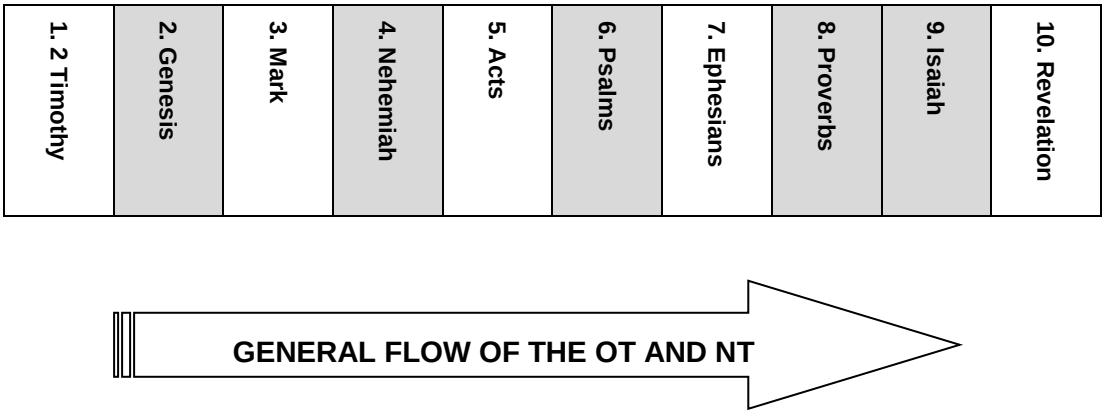
11.5 CONCLUSION

There is an extra section below that not only reinforces what we have been learning, but also explains the flow of the modules in the BUILD curriculum. You might like to cover that now, or return to it later.

Whatever you decide to do, pause and close your main time together by turning some of the key things you have learnt into prayer, using the 'ACTS' pattern above. For example, you might have new things to adore God for, now you have understood the wonder of his word. Give time to prayer.

11.6 EXTRA: THE BUILD MODULES AND THE FLOW OF THE BIBLE

As an extra for personal or group study: one practical way in which the shape of the Bible is used in BUILD is in shaping its curriculum. The way the modules have been arranged is designed to teach some of the principles taught above. The modules follow the flow of the Bible and this is illustrated using the key books the modules are based around:



- What else do you notice about the arrangement of the books? What might this achieve?

- Are there any exceptions to this? Your Trainer will help to point these out and explain them.

Unit 12. 2 Timothy 4:1-5 (Encounter)

This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to 2 Timothy 4:1-5. Refer back to previous 'Encountering the Bible' units for the learning outline and outcomes.

12.1 INTRODUCTION

In this unit you will again apply the lessons of Unit 4 to another, slightly longer passage from 2 Timothy (4:1-5). Keep referring back to the four steps in that unit. By now you should be able to work more independently and be able to identify the parts of the process that you need more help with.

Spend time looking at the text on the next page. Do not forget to read it out loud several times so that you get a feel for it. It is a particularly important passage in 2 Timothy; allow God to speak to you through it.

Use a notepad to write the passage out and record observations and work on these before marking the text in this work book, which you will want to keep for reference.

Your Trainer will help you and guide you through this process.

12.2 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5 – THE PASSAGE

4 In the presence of God and of Christ Jesus, who will judge the living and the dead, and in view of his appearing and his kingdom, I give you this charge: **2** preach the word; be prepared in season and out of season; correct, rebuke and encourage – with great patience and careful instruction. **3** For the time will come when people will not put up with sound doctrine. Instead, to suit their own desires, they will gather round them a great number of teachers to say what their itching ears want to hear. **4** They will turn their ears away from the truth and turn aside to myths. **5** But you, keep your head in all situations, endure hardship, do the work of an evangelist, discharge all the duties of your ministry. (NIV)

12.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5 – STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text	
a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?	
b) See the details of the text. List important words, phrases, and relationships:	**c) Seek the meaning from the details** Explain important words, phrases, and relationships:
d) Summarise the findings. What are the main ideas that come out of this initial study?	

12.4 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text **a) Note all the bones in the structure.** What elements highlight the structure?
b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?
STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text **a) State the theme of the passage.** What is the author's main point?
b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?
STEP 4: BRAIN – understand the PURPOSE of the text... **a) State the purpose of the passage.** Why is the author making his point?
b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

12.5 RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

Unit 13. How to preach a Bible passage (Action)

Overview

We have seen throughout that 2 Timothy emphasises the central place of the Bible (the words of God) and its gospel (the Word of God). It is essential that anyone who leads, teaches and cares for a congregation is able to "preach the Word" (2 Tim 4:2), as we have just seen in Unit 12.

This unit builds on that unit, but also on Unit 3, where you learnt how to discover the original message of a passage of Scripture, and is designed to provide steps to help you to preach or teach that message today.

These steps are essential to the BUILD curriculum and will be used throughout as we constantly move from texts to teaching those texts.

Outline

- Introducing expository preaching
- Completing the 'Scripture Sculpture' process
- The steps of preaching a passage applied to 2 Tim 1:6-7
  STEP 4: BRAIN – state the PURPOSE of the sermon
  STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon
  STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon
  STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon
- Conclusion: Pulling it all together

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Explain how Unit 13 relates to Unit 3
2. Outline the steps of preaching a passage of Scripture
3. Demonstrate how to follow the steps of preaching
4. Evaluate sermons using some simple steps

13.1 INTRODUCING EXPOSITORY PREACHING

13.1.1 Your own experience of preaching

- What are the components of a strong and effective sermon? Think back to some of the best preaching you have heard.

- What makes for a weak and poor sermon? Think back to some of the worst preaching you have heard.

13.1.2 What is expository preaching and why is it important?

- Discuss this question together. There are different kinds or types of sermon, can you think of any different sorts of sermon? What are the strengths and weaknesses of each?

Different types of preaching can have a place in the life of the church. But we have seen from the Pastoral Epistles that all preaching must be the explanation and application of Scripture, the Gospel, and Jesus Christ at the centre. This means that there is a foundational or fundamental type of preaching, which is often called **expository preaching**.

Some people think expository preaching is a style of preaching, one in which the preacher works through the verses in a passage systematically. Expository preaching might or might not involve that method, because expository preaching is not a style of preaching but is an approach to preaching. The word 'expository' describes the foundation, basis or underlying theory of preaching.

- How many sermons have you heard in which the preacher takes a verse of Scripture and then uses it as an opportunity to say whatever he wants to say?

The aim of expository preaching is to **expose** the message of a passage. It is based on a belief that the Bible is God's word and that God speaks through it. We need to simply allow the Bible to speak freely on its own terms, rather than to **impose** our own message on the passage and then on our people. The job of the preacher is simply to let the Bible to do the talking, and to trust that God will speak as he reveals and applies the message of the Bible to our lives today, by his Holy Spirit.

We must not impose our understanding on the Bible, but expository preaching does take the nature and purpose of the Bible into account. In units 9, 10 and 11 we saw the link between **Scripture**, **Salvation**, and the **Saviour**. Scripture has Salvation as its subject and the Saviour as its focus. Expository preaching follows this pattern: we must preach the Bible in the way the Bible is designed to be preached. That makes it a far more exciting and rewarding way to preach. It is like crafting a sculpture out of wood, and going with the grain of the wood rather than going against it, which is messy and hard work. And just as the master craftsman sees a design within the wood, we see God's design in the passage.

Another way of thinking about this is the link between 2 Timothy Chapter 3 and 2 Timothy Chapter 4. Chapter three ends with the Scriptures as the foundation for gospel ministry; Chapter four begins with the charge to preach the gospel. Paul assumes a link between the two – the gospel is preached and Christ is honoured as the Bible is taught.

This also means that expository preaching can evangelise those who are not Christians and encourage those who are – because it constantly teaches the gospel that saves us and which also builds us up. In other words evangelistic preaching is not simply one type of preaching for those who do not yet believe, and expository preaching is another sort for Christians. Expository preaching can be evangelistic, or encouraging, or both.

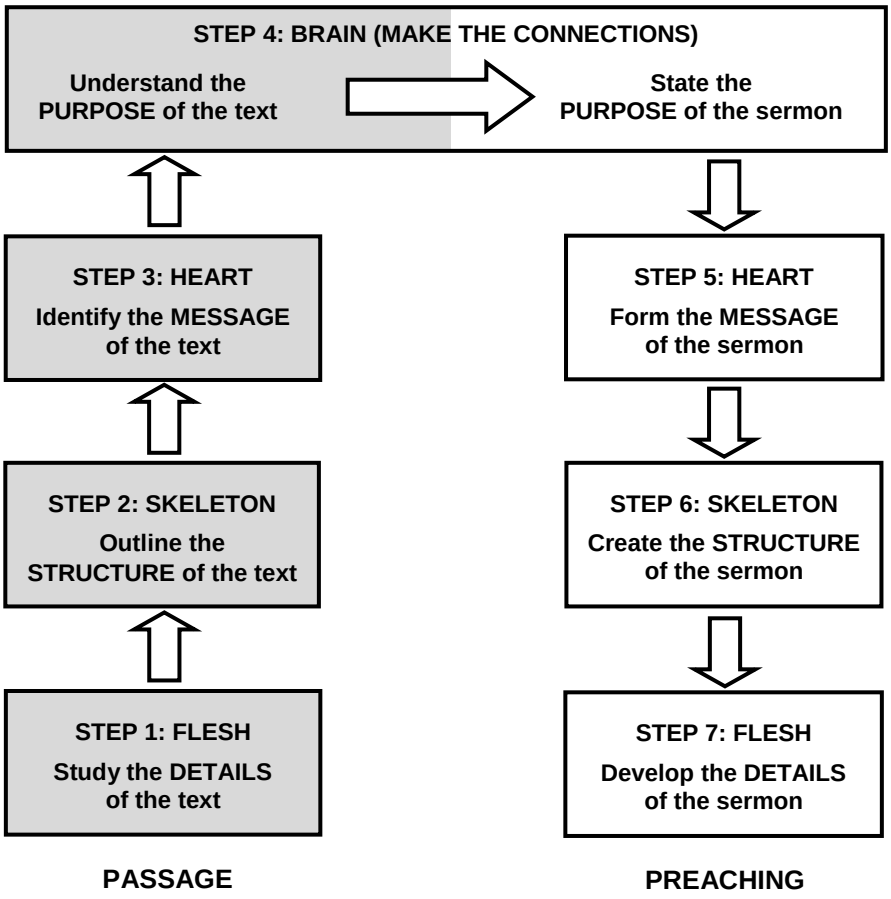
13.2 COMPLETING THE 'SCRIPTURE SCULPTURE' PROCESS

The 'Scripture Sculpture process', which we began to look at in Unit 4, helps us to prepare expository sermons. The process is called 'Scripture Sculpture' because understanding and preaching the Bible is an art: it is the process of taking what God has given us and using that to shape and influence every aspect of a sermon.

In Unit 4 we looked at the first steps of this process: how to **discover** what God has said to his people, a process which we called 'How to encounter a passage of the Bible'. In this unit we will complete the steps by looking at 'How to preach a passage of the Bible', and be able to **declare** what God is saying to his people today.

13.2.1 The seven steps of the Scripture Sculpture process

The whole Scripture Sculpture process is illustrated below, with the steps we have already used to encounter passages of the Pastoral Epistles shaded in grey:



This unit begins at the top of the diagram by extending Step 4 to form a bridge to connect with today's world. It then continues down the right hand side: from the BRAIN of the sermon to the HEART of the sermon to the SKELETON of the sermon to the FLESH of the sermon.

- Learn, memorise and explain the logic to someone else using these key words:

PASSAGE
flesh → skeleton → heart → brain → heart → skeleton → flesh
SERMON

13.2.2 A review of our encounter with 2 Tim 1:6-7

When we come to look at the four steps of preaching a passage of the Bible in detail we will use the same text we studied in Unit 4, which is 2 Tim 1:6-7. We need to review what we have learnt so far in Unit 4 when we encountered that text. This is what we discovered:

STEP 1: FLESH – Study the DETAILS of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we saw that:

- Paul is convinced that Timothy's faith in Christ is genuine.
- Because of this confidence Paul reminds Timothy to do something important. Timothy must renew his confidence in God and his gifts.
- The greatest gift of all is that of God's Holy Spirit with us. He is powerful, loving and self-disciplined.

STEP 2: SKELETON – Outline the STRUCTURE of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we noted:

1. The **introduction** to confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident in his faith (v. 6a) because Paul has already assured him it is "sincere" (v. 5).
2. The **command** to renew confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident that he has the God-given gifts for ministry, therefore he must rekindle them (v. 6b).
3. The **reason** to renew confidence in God and his gifts: God's Spirit is committed and resilient, and we have the presence of this confidence building Spirit in our lives (v. 7).

STEP 3: HEART – Identify the MESSAGE of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we discovered that:

- The theme is, Renewing confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.
- The message from Paul to Timothy is to renew his confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.

STEP 4: BRAIN – Understand the PURPOSE of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we realised that:

- Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts because he is facing an urgent and demanding task, one that he cannot overcome with his own abilities and strength.

We began to make connections and asked this question:

- In the face of all the daily demands and difficulties we face, how can we renew our confidence in God and his gifts for ministry?

13.2.3 The steps of preaching a Bible passage in outline

The table below gives the outcome of each main step, and also breaks that step down into manageable parts for you.

STEP 4: BRAIN – B) State the PURPOSE of the sermon At the end of this step you will be able to state and explain the purpose of the sermon. You need to: a) Keep your **listeners** in mind b) Decide what God wants your people to **understand and obey** c) State the **purpose** of the sermon
STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon At the end of this step you will be able to state and explain the message of the sermon in one or two sentences. You need to: a) State the **theme** of your sermon b) Build on that and state the **message** of your sermon c) **Check** that the message 'works' for your people today
STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon At the end of this step you will have a clear outline for the sermon. You need to: a) Clarify the **main points** or structure of the sermon b) Create an **introduction** c) Develop the **body** d) Have an idea for the **conclusion**
STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon At the end of this step you can preach the sermon to your people. You need to: a) Remember the importance of **words** b) Create **notes** that will help you to preach c) Use your **voice** to communicate d) Take care with **presentation** e) Remember the importance of **evaluation**

13.3 THE STEPS OF PREACHING A PASSAGE APPLIED TO 2 TIM 1:6-7

13.3.1 STEP 4: BRAIN – state the PURPOSE of the sermon

At the end of this step you will be able to explain the purpose of your sermon to someone.

> **Remember:** The purpose statement acts as a bridge in the process of teaching the passage today. Once you know why the text is in the Bible – what it is there to achieve – you can develop a purpose for your sermon or teaching.

It is important to have a clear purpose for the sermon for a number of reasons. Adapting and building on Ramesh Richard:

- **The purpose** can help you to establish and form the sermon's heart.
- **The purpose** can help with the sermon's introduction.
- **The purpose** helps you decide what to include and what to leave out.
- **The purpose** guides the application and conclusion of the sermon.
- **The purpose** helps you to evaluate the sermon.
- **The purpose** gives you a sense of purpose as you preach the sermon.

We have already begun on this step because we have come to **understand the PURPOSE of the text**. In Unit 4 we discovered this purpose for 2 Tim 1:6-7:

- Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts because he is facing an urgent and demanding task, one that he cannot overcome with his own abilities and strength.

We took that a step further and began to **translate it into the PURPOSE of the sermon**. In Unit 4 we began to build a bridge and to make some connections with our own context today. That led to the purpose expressed as a question:

- In the face of all the daily demands and difficulties we face, how can we renew our confidence in God and his gifts for ministry?

That is a good general statement of purpose for a sermon based on 2 Tim 1:6-7. Because of the nature of 2 Timothy. But it will need to be tailored for most situations and congregations. You need to learn **how to create a purpose statement for your listeners**.

a) Keep your listeners in mind

We must keep our listeners in mind. Pray for your listeners in the light of the passage. We need to consider their needs and situations. Real sermons are not abstract lectures. As you learn to preach in the BUILD group that must also be the case. Think about a sermon you will preach on Sunday to your congregation. Or think about what you would say if you were to speak to your BUILD group: imagine that your fellow BUILD participants are your congregation.

b) Consider what God wants your listeners to know and obey

Ask and answer this question, in the light of the Bible passage: What does God want my listeners to know and obey?

As you do so, continue to reflect on the heart of the text, its theme and message. That theme was confidence for ministry. And the message to Timothy was that he can be confident that he has everything he needs for his ministry: the gifts of the Spirit and the gift of the Spirit. And it is vital to be guided by the brain of the text, its purpose, which is to renew confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.

It may help to complete these two statements:

> God wants my listeners to know this truth:…
>
> And, God wants my listeners to obey that truth in these ways:…

You can then combine those statements.

- Work together now on answering the question, What does God want my listeners to know and to obey?

c) State the purpose of the sermon

That statement comes from turning your answers above into a single statement, beginning with these words: “The purpose of my sermon is...”

- Turn your thinking into a single statement of your sermon’s purpose. Begin that statement with these words: “The purpose of my sermon is...”

CHURCH HEALTH WARNING: If you do not know what your sermon’s purpose is, DO NOT PREACH IT! In other words do not preach unless you know why you are preaching!

13.3.2 STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon

At the end of this step you will be able to state and explain the theme and message of the sermon in one or two sentences.

> **Remember:** You can use the heart of the passage, together with the brain and connections you have begun to make, to form the heart of your sermon – the message or main point you will communicate.

a) State the theme of your sermon

This may well flow from the brain of the sermon. The theme of the sermon is simply your main point, the main thing you are talking about, your subject.

- Building on your purpose statement, what will you be talking about?

The theme can be given as a simple statement: 'How to keep going with gospel ministry.' Or it can be explored in the form of a question: 'How can we keep going with gospel ministry?'

b) Build on that and state the message of your sermon

The message of your sermon is what you will be saying about that theme. In other words, what will you be saying about what you are talking about?

- Can you develop a message from that theme, which is faithful to 2 Tim 1:6-7?

c) Check that the message 'works' for your people today

This means thinking a bit more about your audience and their situation. Think about the words: are they simple, clear and alive? Will the heart of my sermon get to the heart of this group of people? Is the message memorable?

- Rework and restate the message of the sermon if necessary.

13.3.3 STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon

At the end of this step you will have a clear outline for the sermon.

> **Remember:** The purpose and message of your sermon will help you to create the structure of the sermon.
>
> This form may be different to the structure of the passage, but it will always draw on it and be guided by it.

a) Clarify the main points or structure of the sermon

The structure must serve the purpose, the message, the explanation of the passage and the audience. It can be informed by the passage, but remember that the structure of the passage was designed to communicate the message to the original audience and it may or may not be the best form for your people today.

The skeleton of the passage may provide a general guide. For example, when teaching proverbs, it might be appropriate to make some short memorable statements that work as proverbs for today. Or if you are looking at a biblical story, it might be appropriate to simply use the story, or a similar story, as a framework.

It might be that in the passage:

- There are 3 ideas you can use as a structure
- There are 2 questions it asks
- There are 4 steps it encourages people to take
- There is a contrast it makes that can shape your sermon
- There are 4 emotions it communicates
- There are 3 ways it makes the same point
- There is a puzzle to be solved – you can (1) state the puzzle, (2) solve the puzzle, (3) apply the puzzle and solution to our lives

- Can you list other possibilities?

- How would you structure a sermon on 2 Timothy 1:6-7? Give an outline below:

b) Develop the body

Developing the body of the talk often means thinking through how those points will be made. This usually means the following:

- Stating a point clearly
- Explaining a point simply
- Illustrating a point to shed light on it
- Applying a point to the lives of the listeners
- Linking that point on to the next one or into the conclusion

Good application is important, and will be guided by the message and purpose you have given the sermon. Preachers tend to give too little thought and time to this area. Prayer is important throughout sermon preparation, but it is particularly important when it comes to application. We will build on these areas throughout the curriculum but we must:

1) Encourage <u>repentance and faith</u>
The biblical pattern for transformation is through **repentance** and **faith**. That means turning away from sinful thoughts, words, deeds and habits, and turning to Christ and walking in his way. Both must be held together. Repentance without faith is moralistic. Faith without repentance is hollow.

We need to encourage people to turn away from wrong thinking and wrong living, and to embrace Christ's way. Encouraging them to embrace Christ's way must point them to the liberating message of the cross, and the encouraging presence and power of the Spirit.

2. Engage <u>mind, heart and will</u>
Applications can include challenges that change people's thinking. But they must also include ways of changing people's character and behaviour.

c) Create an introduction

An introduction grabs and holds the listeners attention, taking them from their world of distractions and concerns, and into the world of the Bible and the sermon. Therefore it should relate to both those worlds: the world of the listener and the world of the Bible.

- It might be a story that leads into the purpose of the sermon and the passage of the bible.

- It could be a question that is relevant to the listener and which the passage answers.

The BRAIN of the sermon will be particularly helpful here.

- What introduction might work for our sermon on 2 Tim 1:6-7?

d) Have an idea for the conclusion

A good conclusion is also important, and tends to be neglected. The conclusion takes the listener back into their world, and, when part of corporate worship, into the rest of the service.

- It might be a summary of the sermon, but it should not simply be that
- It might be a fresh twist that reinforces the point
- It might lead back to the introduction and build on that
- It might be a set of applications that lead to specific prayer or prayer ministry

- How would you conclude our sermon on 2 Tim 1:6-7?

13.3.4 STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon

At the end of this step you can preach the sermon to your people.

> **Remember:** You can finally put some flesh and skin on the bones and create the sermon. Ask God to breathe his Spirit into the message and you, his messenger.

a) Remember the importance of words

Preaching is more than words (what other aspects of communication are there?).

But preaching is never less than words, and the choice of words is important.

Think carefully about how you will put things as you flesh out the skeleton.

b) Create notes that will help you to preach

What sort of notes should you create to help you to deliver your sermon? People have different answers to this question.

No notes? ⟷ A full manuscript?

Some people say that you do not need any notes at all. People say that notes inhibit you. Others say that you should have a full manuscript.

The answer probably lies somewhere in between and you need to learn what works best for you. In practice the more work you put into this the *less* you will be inhibited.

NOTE: People also think that it is easy to give a short talk. But the shorter the talk is the more time you will need to give to preparing notes for every minute that you speak.

c) Use your voice to communicate

Good use of your voice is not about *volume* but *variety*. Remember to vary and use these four words:

- Pitch (vary the tone of your voice)
- Pace (vary the speed of your delivery)
- Pause (stop speaking for a moment or two to give space for thought)
- Power (vary the intensity and volume)

Trainers need to explain and demonstrate this. Explain that a culture of shouting can hinder real communication and learning.

d) Take care with presentation

Be yourself but think how you will best serve the listeners.

Practice your preaching. Some people think that this is 'unspiritual'. But time given to going over your message and praying over your message will give you more confidence and freedom. Become familiar with your sermon and remember to preach it to yourself first.

e) Do not forget the importance of evaluation

A simple form of evaluation is to use the questions:

Was the sermon TRUE?	Did the **message** come from the Bible? Was it true to the text and to the gospel? Was it God's word?
Was the sermon RELEVANT?	Was there a **purpose**, and were there specific applications for the listeners?
Was the sermon CLEAR?	Was there good explanation and a clear **structure** that was easy to follow? Was the communication good?

Evaluate yourself: Do this first, as you prepare and practice. Are you clear on what you are preaching, why you are preaching it and how you are delivering it? If not, there is a problem.

Get others to evaluate you: Allow others to give constructive criticism at the appropriate moment after the sermon using the questions above. You might want to ask someone in advance to do this. When you are evaluating people always begin with some genuine encouragement. It may be best to only give encouragement straight afterwards and to then offer further constructive criticism later on.

13.4 CONCLUSION: PULLING IT ALL TOGETHER

13.4.1 Ezekiel 37:1-14 and the breath of God

On the next page there is a table that will help you pull together the findings for 2 Tim 1:6-7 from the work we have done. We will use a similar table throughout the rest of the curriculum.

But to conclude this unit we will look at Ezekiel 37:1-14 and the powerful picture it contains.

- Before you read it together as a group read the following notes:

  Ezekiel is a prophet and is called to preach to Israel. However, the message of Ezekiel 37 is not mainly about the work of a preacher. Ezekiel 37 is a vision of Israel being resurrected and restored by God after the punishment of the Exile.

  But Ezekiel is commanded to preach or prophesy to the bones in this vision, and, in the context of Scripture Sculpture, it is a powerful picture of flesh and skeleton, heart and brain, skin and bones coming together.

  Without the breath of God, the Spirit of God, the bones will remain bones. We need to pray throughout the process of preparing to preach and ask God the Holy Spirit, who inspired the Scriptures, to breathe his new life into our preaching and through it, into the lives of our listeners.

- Now read Ezekiel 37:1-14 with this background in mind.

In the context of the Pastoral Epistles, Paul tells Timothy to guard the gospel “with the help of the Holy Spirit who lives in us” (2 Tim 1:14). God longs to use us to guard the gospel, not least as we preach and teach, and he gives us the strength of his Holy Spirit to empower us for that task.

- End this unit with prayer for one another in this important area.

13.4.2 Preaching the message of 2 Tim 1:6-7

Use the table below to record the key ideas we have discussed for a sermon or talk:

STEP 4: BRAIN – state the PURPOSE of the sermon My sermon's purpose statement:
STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon My sermon's theme and its message statement:
STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon My sermon's outline (with the main points, introduction and conclusion):
STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon My sermon's details (note here key words, explanations, illustrations and applications that will help you write notes or a full sermon):

Unit 14. Titus 1:5-9 (Encounter)

Overview

This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to Titus 1:5-9. In doing so it provides the learners with the opportunity to look at a passage from elsewhere in the pastorals, both as an appetiser and as an important passage in itself that leads into the final unit of the module.

Outline

- Introduction: Understanding Titus
- Understanding the Pastoral Epistles
- Worksheet for the passage
- Worksheet for Step 1
- Worksheet for Steps 2 to 4
- Preaching Titus 1:5-9

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Recall and apply the four steps of Encountering a Bible Passage to a passage from Titus
2. Explain the message of Titus 1:5-9 to a group of pastors today
3. Apply Titus 1:5-9 and evaluate your own life and ministry

14.1 INTRODUCTION: UNDERSTANDING TITUS

Titus is the final letter of the Pastoral Epistles. We have dipped into it already, particularly when looking at the gospel and how to share it in Units 6 and 7.

You will remember from Units 2 and 3 that in order to understand a Bible passage we must ‘Keep in mind the original CONTEXT of the Bible book’.

We noted that, ‘Trying to understand a passage of a book without knowing the book itself is like trying to get to know a member of a family without knowing their wider family and where they live.’

Before we look at Titus 1:5-9 we will do an introductory study of it, guided by Unit 3. We have already completed that exercise for 1 and 2 Timothy. We will build on that by thinking through some of the similarities and differences between Titus and 1 Timothy, the book that was written before Titus.

If you have enough time together read Titus through as a whole, it is shorter than the other letters. If you have limited time just look at the verses that are mentioned below, and read through Titus later.

14.1.1 Establish the context of Titus

Read through the book and look for indicators of the context. (Who is addressing whom? Who else is involved? Where is it being written to and from? Why has it been written?)

Note specific verses where you see either a **similarity** to 1 Timothy (things that are nearly the same), or a **difference** to it. Describe those similarities and differences by looking at the two books and moving between them.

- What **similarities** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the context?

Titus 1:4

Titus 1:5-9

Titus 1:10-11

Titus 2:1

Titus 3:12

- What **differences** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the context?

Titus 1:4

Titus 1:5, 12

14.1.2 Discover the content of Titus

As we have looked at the **context** of 2 Timothy we have begun to note the **content**. Build on that now by looking more closely at the content, the themes of the book.

- What **similarities** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the content?

Titus 1:9; 2:15

Titus 1:5-9

Titus 2:10b; 3:1-2, 8, 14

- What **differences** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the content?

Titus 1:1-3

Titus 2:11-14 and 3:3-7

You will grow in your understanding of Titus as you look at the passage that follows and connect it to the rest of the book. We will turn to that passage in a moment and apply the 4 steps of Encountering a Bible Passage to it.

But before we do, and now that we have looked at the background to all three books, we will look briefly at understanding the Pastoral Epistles as a whole.

14.2 UNDERSTANDING THE PASTORAL EPISTLES

14.2.1 The relationship between the individual Pastoral Epistles

We have now looked at the background of all three Pastoral Epistles: 1 Timothy, 2 Timothy and Titus. This is a good moment to use the similarities and differences between the letters to illustrate the relationship between the books. 1 and 2 Timothy have naturally been grouped together in our Bibles, but it seems that they were written in the order below:

1 Timothy

- From Paul who is in Macedonia (1:3) and free to travel, leaving Timothy in Ephesus.
- False teachers have already emerged from within the church leadership, they have established themselves and have begun to destroy the church.
- Being a true teacher of the gospel means stopping the false teachers and appointing other true teachers: this is the essential task.
- This is urgent and important.
- 1 Tim is probably the first of the three letters to be written.

Titus

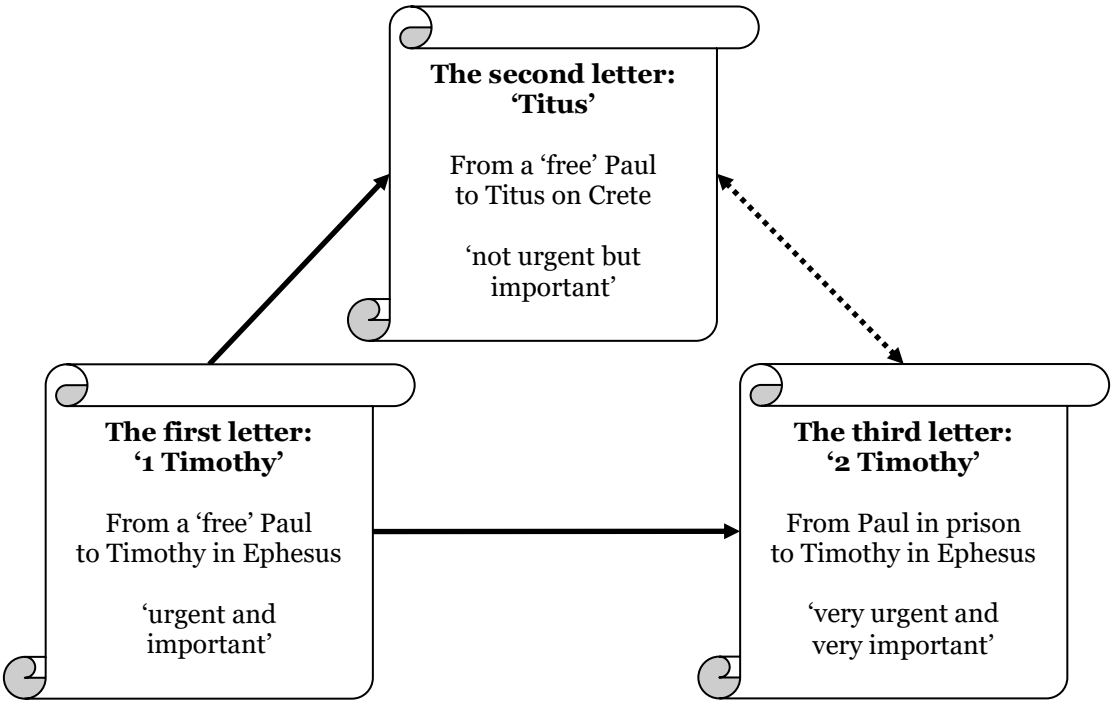
- From Paul who is still in Macedonia ("Nicopolis" on the coast, 3:12) and free to travel, leaving Titus on Crete.
- False teachers are already on the scene but the problems are less severe.
- Being a true teacher of the gospel and appointing other true teachers is still vital in order to protect the churches as they develop.
- This task is important but less urgent.
- Titus is probably the second of the three letters: it seems to be based on 1 Timothy but written for a different setting.

2 Timothy

- From Paul who is imprisoned in Rome and facing death, to Timothy in Ephesus.
- Being a true teacher of the gospel and passing gospel ministry on to other true teachers is now more important than ever. Partly so that Timothy can go to Paul's side, and partly so that true gospel ministry will continue and flourish.
- It is serious, extremely urgent, and highly important.

14.2.2 A way of illustrating the way the relationship between the three letters

The relationship between the three letters can be pictured in the way shown below.



The solid lines show direct connections: There is a direct connection between 1 Timothy and Titus: after writing 1 Timothy Paul may well have turned his attention to the less urgent, but still important, matters on Crete, using some of the same material.

And there is a direct connection between 1 Timothy and 2 Timothy: with Paul's imprisonment and a worsening situation in Ephesus he builds on 1 Timothy in 2 Timothy.

The dashed line shows an indirect link: There is only an indirect connection between 2 Timothy and Titus – they both relate to similar issues, and both arose out of 1 Timothy, but Paul is writing to different people in different places.

14.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING TITUS 1:5-9 – THE PASSAGE

5 The reason I left you in Crete was that
you might put in order what was left
unfinished and appoint elders in every
town, as I directed you. 6 An elder must be
blameless, faithful to his wife, a man
whose children believe and are not open
to the charge of being wild and
disobedient. 7 Since an overseer manages
God's household, he must be blameless –
not overbearing, not quick-tempered, not
given to drunkenness, not violent, not
pursuing dishonest gain. 8 Rather, he must
be hospitable, one who loves what is good,
who is self-controlled, upright, holy and
disciplined. 9 He must hold firmly to the
trustworthy message as it has been
taught, so that he can encourage others by
sound doctrine and refute those who
oppose it. (NIV)

14.4 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING TITUS 1:5-9 – STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?

b) See the details of the text. List important words, phrases, and relationships:	**c) Seek the meaning from the details** Explain important words, phrases, and relationships:

d) Summarise the findings. What are the main ideas that come out of this initial study?

14.5 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING TITUS 1:5-9 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text **a) Note all the bones in the structure.** What elements highlight the structure?
b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?
STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text **a) State the theme of the passage.** What is the author's main point?
b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?
STEP 4: BRAIN – understand the PURPOSE of the text... **a) State the purpose of the passage.** Why is the author making his point?
b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

14.6 PREACHING TITUS 1:5-9

In order to consider preaching Titus 1:5-9 we will, first, respond to the message at a more personal level, picking up on the discoveries we have already made. We will then use the table on the next page to capture some key ideas for a sermon or talk.

14.6.1 Responding to the message of Titus 1:5-9

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

14.6.2 Preaching the message of Titus 1:5-9

Use the table below to outline some of the key ideas for a sermon or talk:

STEP 4: BRAIN – State the PURPOSE of the sermon My sermon's purpose statement:
STEP 5: HEART – Form the MESSAGE of the sermon My sermon's theme and its message statement:
STEP 6: SKELETON – Create the STRUCTURE of the sermon My sermon's outline (with the main points, introduction and conclusion):
STEP 7: FLESH – Develop the DETAILS of the sermon My sermon's details (note here key words, explanations, illustrations and applications that will help you write notes or a full sermon):

Unit 15. Leaders of integrity (Action)

Overview

The module closes with a major emphasis of the pastorals and one that is central to the BUILD programme: integrity. And it provides an opportunity to review the module and the Pastoral Epistles from that perspective. Finally, it ends with a commitment to live out the truth of the gospel in ways that will build up other leaders and the churches.

Outline

- The meaning and importance of integrity
- Lessons on integrity in Module One
- Conclusion: Being leaders of integrity

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Define the meaning of the word integrity
2. Illustrate the meaning and importance of integrity from Module One
3. Repent of hypocrisy and commit to being a leader of integrity

15.1 INTRODUCTION: THE GOSPEL AND GODLINESS

"Preaching the Gospel and Godly Leadership" is this module's subtitle. From beginning to end the Pastoral Epistles are about the gospel and godliness. The gospel and godliness belong together: leaders must know and teach the true gospel and, strengthened by it, must live lives that illustrate the good news. The module's anchor verse makes that point:

> "Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth." (2 Tim 2:15)

- Memorise that verse if you have not done so already.

- In what ways does the verse emphasise both what we <u>believe</u> and how we <u>behave</u> (the gospel and godliness)?

'Godliness' is just one of the words in the Pastoral Epistles that describes character that is based on the gospel.

- What other words in the Pastoral Epistles can you think of that describe what we must be like as leaders? Make a list of these words.

- How do we measure up to this list and how do other leaders around us measure up?

15.2 THE MEANING AND IMPORTANCE OF INTEGRITY

'Integrity' might have been one of the words in your list. In the situations we face locally in leadership it is one of the most important ones. It is found in Titus 2:7-8, which is given below. We will explore the meaning and importance of integrity, based on that passage.

> "In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us." Titus 2:7-8

Remember, we have learnt that we can discover the meaning of a word by looking at the context it is used in. We will therefore ask and answer this question:

- What light does the context of Titus 2:7-8 shed on the meaning of the word integrity?

We will answer that question by working outwards from the smallest unit to the largest: from the phrase the word is set in, to the sentence it is set in, to the paragraph that provides its context, to the section of teaching that gives a wider context, to the argument of the book so far.

1. What do we learn from the phrase the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech..."

- What do you learn from this phrase?

2. What do we learn from the sentence the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us."

- What do you learn from this sentence?

3. What do we learn from the paragraph the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us."

- What do you learn from this paragraph, including its first sentence?

4. What do we learn from the section of teaching the word 'integrity' is set in?

Look at Titus 2:1-10.

- What do we learn about integrity from that section of teaching?

5. What do we learn about integrity from the argument of the book so far?

Look at Titus 1:1-16, the passage that leads up to the one we have been studying.

- What do you learn from the argument of the book so far?

- Sum up what you have learnt so far. What is integrity and why does it matter?

15.3 LESSONS ON INTEGRITY IN MODULE ONE

Because the gospel and godliness are central to the Pastoral Epistles it is no surprise that the idea of integrity has come up repeatedly. Take a look back through the module with these questions in mind:

- Where does the idea of integrity come earlier in the module?
- How do earlier units reinforce our learning about integrity?
- What new ideas about integrity do you notice from earlier units?

Use the blank spaces between the list of units below to make notes:

Unit 1. Introducing BUILD

Unit 2. How to hear God's voice today

Unit 3. Understanding 1 and 2 Timothy (Tools)

Unit 4. How to encounter a passage of the Bible

Unit 5. Encountering 2 Timothy 1:8-12

Unit 6. What is the gospel?

Unit 7. Sharing the gospel

Unit 8. Encountering 2 Timothy 2:1-7

Unit 9. Gospel centred ministry

Unit 10. Encountering 2 Timothy 3:14-17

Unit 11. The Bible and biblical ministry

Unit 12. Encountering 2 Timothy 4:1-5

Unit 13. How to preach a passage of the Bible

Unit 14. Encountering Titus 1:5-9

15.4 CONCLUSION: BEING LEADERS OF INTEGRITY

Give time individually or in a group to committing yourselves to lives of integrity for the sake of God and the gospel. This will involve both repentance – turning away from hypocrisy and habits that undermine our integrity, and faith – trusting in God's strength and the power of his Spirit to live lives that will point to Christ and his kingdom. You might like to read some of these verses as your make this commitment:

"As for you, if you walk before me in **integrity** of heart and uprightness, as David your father did, and do all I command and observe my decrees and laws ..." (1 Kings 9:4)

"… you test the heart and are pleased with **integrity**." (1 Chronicles 29:17)

"I put in charge of Jerusalem my brother Hanani... because he was a man of **integrity** and feared God more than most men do." (Nehemiah 7:2)

"[Job] is blameless and upright, a man who fears God and shuns evil. And he still maintains his **integrity** ..." (Job 2:3)

"Relent, do not be unjust; reconsider, for my **integrity** is at stake." (Job 6:29)

"Judge me, O LORD, according to my righteousness, according to my **integrity**, O Most High." (Psalm 7:8)

"May **integrity** and uprightness protect me, because my hope is in you." (Psalm 25:21)

"In my **integrity** you uphold me and set me in your presence forever." (Psalm 41:12)

"And David shepherded them with **integrity** of heart; with skilful hands he led them." (Psalm 78:72)

"The man of **integrity** walks securely, but he who takes crooked paths will be found out." (Proverbs 10:9)

"The **integrity** of the upright guides them, but the unfaithful are destroyed by their duplicity." (Proverbs 11:3)

"No one calls for justice; no one pleads his case with **integrity**. They rely on empty arguments and speak lies; they conceive trouble and give birth to evil." (Isaiah 59:4)

"They came to him and said, "Teacher, we know you are a man of **integrity**. You aren't swayed by men, because you pay no attention to who they are; but you teach the way of God in accordance with the truth. Is it right to pay taxes to Caesar or not?" (Mark 12:14)

"In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness ..." (Titus 2:7)

Review questions for Module One

- Look back through the titles of the units in the module. Which units had the greatest impact on you and why is that the case?

- Think back to your time in and use of the module. In what ways has your leadership been challenged and changed as a result of the module?

- In a similar way, reflect on the ways in which your church has been influenced by any teaching from the module, which you have passed on in some way.

Contents of upcoming modules

Module Two **Genesis & the Pentateuch:**
Knowing God's Story & Leading by Faith

Unit 1. The Pentateuch and the Bible's story (Tools)
Unit 2. Genesis 12:1-9 and God's salvation plan (Tools)
Unit 3. Understanding Bible stories (Tools)
Unit 4. Genesis 1:1-2:3 (Encounter)
Unit 5. God's world and our worldviews (Reflection)
Unit 6. Stewardship and sustainability (Action)
Unit 7. Genesis 11:1-9 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Sin and evil (Reflection)
Unit 9. Genesis 15 (Encounter)
Unit 10. God's covenants and our covenants (Reflection)
Unit 11. Exodus 3:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Jesus and the Old Testament (Reflection)
Unit 13. Encountering the Law (Tools)
Unit 14. Deuteronomy 5:6-21 (Encounter)
Unit 15. Leading by faith (Action)

Module Three **Mark & the Gospels:**
The Servant King & Servant Leadership

Unit 1. Introducing Mark and the gospels (Tools)
Unit 2. Mark 2:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 3. Understanding the kingdom of God (Reflection)
Unit 4. How to encounter parables (Tools)
Unit 5. Mark 4:26-33 (Encounter)
Unit 6. Proclaiming the kingdom of God (Action)
Unit 7. Matthew 5:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Poverty and prosperity (Reflection)
Unit 9. Matthew 6:5-15 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Praying for the kingdom of God (Action)
Unit 11. Mark 8:31-9:1 (Encounter)
Unit 12. The servant king and servant leadership (Reflection)
Unit 13. Mark 12:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 14. The cross and the Lord's Supper (Reflection)
Unit 15. Making disciples (Action)

Module Four **Nehemiah & the Historical Books:**
Building God's People & Strategic Leadership

Unit 1. Building the Bible's story (Tools)
Unit 2. Encountering Ruth (Tools)
Unit 3. Nehemiah 1 (Encounter)
Unit 4. Intercession (Action)
Unit 5. Nehemiah 2:11-20 (Encounter)
Unit 6. Mobilising God's people (Action)
Unit 7. Nehemiah 4 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Facing opposition (Action)
Unit 9. Nehemiah 5 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Poverty alleviation (Action)
Unit 11. Nehemiah 8:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Expository preaching (Action)
Unit 13. Leading small groups (Action)
Unit 14. Building God's people (Reflection)
Unit 15. Strategic leadership (Action)

Module Five **Acts & the New Testament Story:**
The Mission of the Church & Missional Leadership

Unit 1. Encountering Acts and the NT Story (Tools)
Unit 2. Encountering Acts 2:1-13 (Encounter)
Unit 3. God's mission and our mission (Reflection)
Unit 4. Encountering Acts 2:42-47 (Encounter)
Unit 5. Mission shaped church (Action)
Unit 6. Encountering Acts 8:9-25 (Encounter)
Unit 7. The Holy Spirit and baptism (Reflection)
Unit 8. Deliverance and healing (Action)
Unit 9. Encountering Acts 15:36-41 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Handling conflict (Action)
Unit 11. Christian mission and local culture (Reflection)
Unit 12. Encountering Acts 17:16-34 (Encounter)
Unit 13. Christ's Lordship and other religions (Reflection)
Unit 14. Evangelistic speaking (Action)
Unit 15. Missional leadership (Action)

Module Six **Psalms & Poetry:**
Worshipping the King & Wholehearted Leadership

Unit 1. Encountering the Psalms and Poetry (Tools)
Unit 2. Psalm 23 (Encounter)
Unit 3. Guidance: How God leads his people (Reflection)
Unit 4. Psalm 51 (Encounter)
Unit 5. Wholehearted leadership (Reflection)
Unit 6. Kingship and Christ in the Psalms (Tools)
Unit 7. Psalm 73 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Reflection & action, learning & teaching (Tools)
Unit 9. Songs of suffering (Reflection)
Unit 10. Dying & death, burial & bereavement (Action)
Unit 11. Psalm 95 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Worshipping the King (Action)
Unit 13. Psalm 127 (Encounter)
Unit 14. The pastor's family and God's family (Action)
Unit 15. Learning from your church's story (Reflection)

Module Seven **Ephesians & the Epistles:**
God's Plan for the Church & Local Church Leadership

Unit 1. Understanding Ephesians and the Epistles (Tools)
Unit 2. Ephesians 1:3-10 (Encounter)
Unit 3. Confidence in Christ (Reflection)
Unit 4. Ephesians 3:7-13 (Encounter)
Unit 5. God's plan for the church (Reflection)
Unit 6. Ephesians 4:11-16 (Encounter)
Unit 7. Transforming church leadership (Action)
Unit 8. Ephesians 4:29-32 (Encounter)
Unit 9. Building a new community (Action)
Unit 10. Ephesians 5:25-33 (Encounter)
Unit 11. Building Bible interpretation skills (Tools)
Unit 12. Gender, marriage and ministry (Reflection)
Unit 13. Understanding the Trinity (Reflection)
Unit 14. Ephesians 6:10-17 (Encounter)
Unit 15. Spiritual warfare (Action)

Module Eight **Proverbs & Wisdom:**
The Fear of the Lord & Practical Leadership

Unit 1. Introducing wisdom (Tools)
Unit 2. Encountering Proverbs (Tools)
Unit 3. Proverbs 3:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 4. Wisdom for leadership I (Reflection)
Unit 5. Proverbs 5:15-23 (Encounter)
Unit 6. The Song, sex and sexuality (Reflection)
Unit 7. Issues facing the church: HIV and AIDS (Action)
Unit 8. Proverbs 11:23-27 and 13:7-11 (Encounter)
Unit 9. Wisdom with funds (Action)
Unit 10. Proverbs 20:5-12 (Encounter)
Unit 11. Wise counsel (Action)
Unit 12. Proverbs 27:11-22 (Encounter)
Unit 13. Working with children and young people (Action)
Unit 14. Ecclesiastes 3:1-8 (Encounter)
Unit 15. Wisdom for Leadership II (Action)

Module Nine **Isaiah & the Prophets:**
The Sovereign King & Prophetic Leadership

Unit 1. Encountering the Prophets (Tools)
Unit 2. Introducing Isaiah (Tools)
Unit 3. Isaiah 6 (Encounter)
Unit 4. Preaching the Prophets (Action)
Unit 5. Isaiah 12 (Encounter)
Unit 6. Prophecy today (Reflection)
Unit 7. Isaiah 40:1-11 (Encounter)
Unit 8. “Here is your God!” (Reflection)
Unit 9. Isaiah 53:1-6 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Isaiah, Christ and the New Testament (Reflection)
Unit 11. Isaiah 58:6-9 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Advocacy and the local church (Action)
Unit 13. Isaiah 61:1-4 (Encounter)
Unit 14. A great commission (Reflection)
Unit 15. Prophetic leadership (Action)

Module Ten **Revelation & Apocalyptic:**
The Victorious Christ & Leaders that Endure

Unit 1. Introducing Revelation (Tools)
Unit 2. Exploring Revelation and Apocalyptic (Tools)
Unit 3. Revelation 1:12-18 (Encounter)
Unit 4. A leader’s vision of Christ (Reflection)
Unit 5. Revelation 2:1-7 (Encounter)
Unit 6. A leader’s vision of the church (Reflection)
Unit 7. Revelation 5:1-10 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Revelation 6:1-8 (Encounter)
Unit 9. A leader’s vision of history (Reflection)
Unit 10. Persecution and martyrdom (Action)
Unit 11. Revelation 19:11-21 (Encounter)
Unit 12. A leader’s vision of judgment (Reflection)
Unit 13. Revelation 21:1-8 (Encounter)
Unit 14. A leader’s vision of heaven (Reflection)
Unit 15. Leaders that endure (Action)